against Margot had been filed at the beginning of August by Gisela Mauritz concerning the compulsory adoption of her son, Alexander. (There was, however, another story about allegations of children being abused and driven to suicide in a prison-like barrack in Torgau known – according to the Western media – as ‘Margot’s Concentration camp’. She managed to avoid prosecution).12

‘In Germany, the hunt against you, my little one, will continue,’ Honecker wrote in a short, tender note to his wife. ‘That hurts … The judiciary of the FRG has no right to sit in court over you, who has served your state loyally and successfully.’